

I've spoken to lots of different people over the course of my career about the relationship between how they feel about money and how they feel about themselves. People in all kinds of financial situations, from all kinds of different backgrounds, each of them with a different history of struggling in some way with their relationship with money. And for each and every one of them, their relationship with money is completely inextricable from their relationship with themselves. It's inextricable from what they think of themselves, from the esteem that they hold themselves in. Some people cling desperately to every penny they earn, believing that they are only worth what they can save. Some people spend everything in sight, and then some, because they don't believe they're worthy of financial peace. Some climb the career ladder furiously, in search of a salary that will make them feel that they've finally arrived, while others are afraid to negotiate better pay because they don't believe that they're worth it. There are so many ways in which your relationship with money can be broken – but that doesn't mean that it can't be fixed.

Deriving your self-worth from your net worth might mean that:

- You struggle to see a way out of financial difficulty.
- You don't feel deserving of the money that you have or the salary that you earn.
- You constantly strive for more and more money, and it never feels like enough.